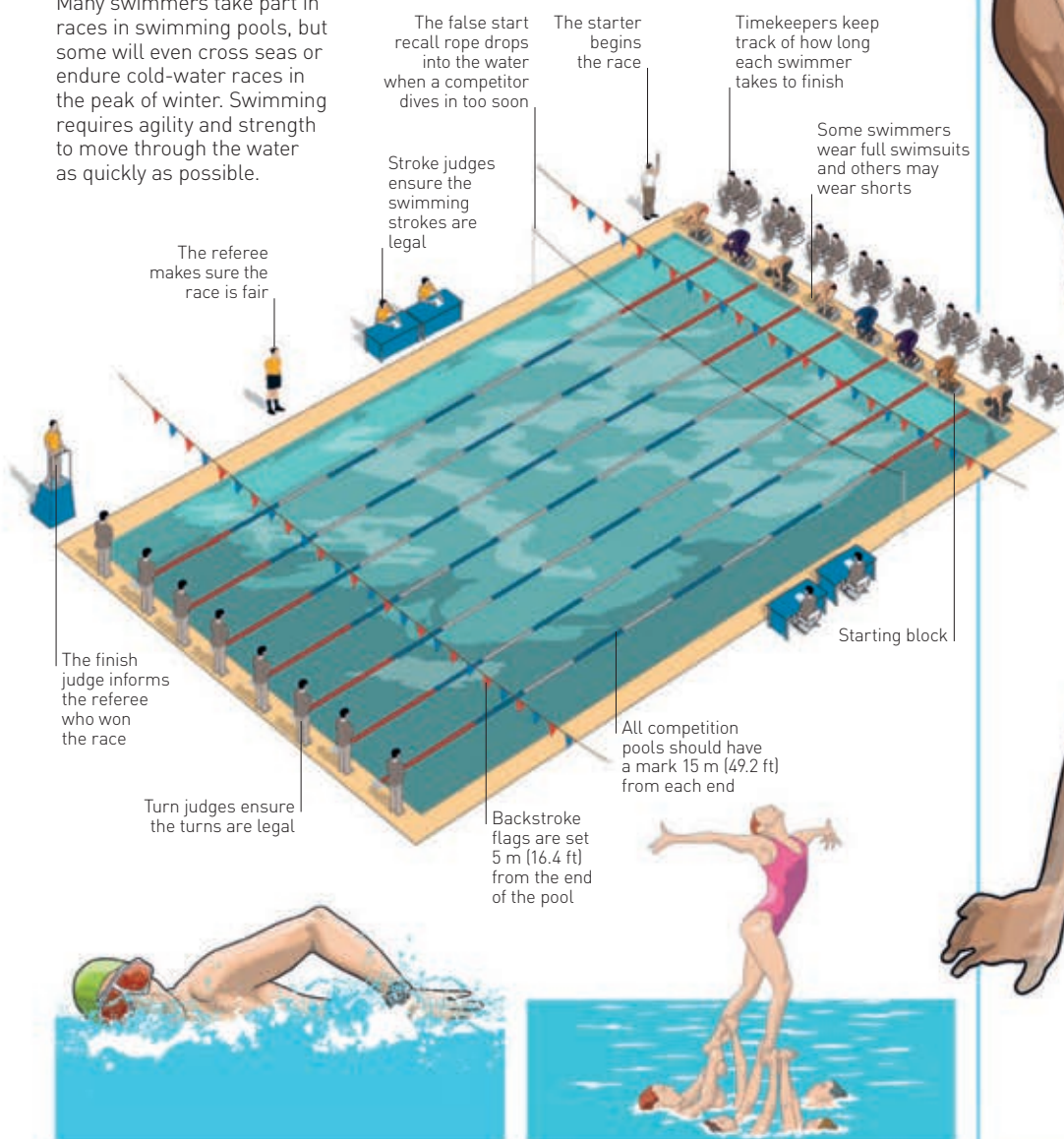


# Water sports

Water provides the perfect environment to show off sporting skills, from impressive tricks on a board to acrobatic dives into the water. Water sports are exciting and require great balance, strength, and endurance to keep control in the water.

## SWIMMING

Many swimmers take part in races in swimming pools, but some will even cross seas or endure cold-water races in the peak of winter. Swimming requires agility and strength to move through the water as quickly as possible.



### SOLO SWIMMING

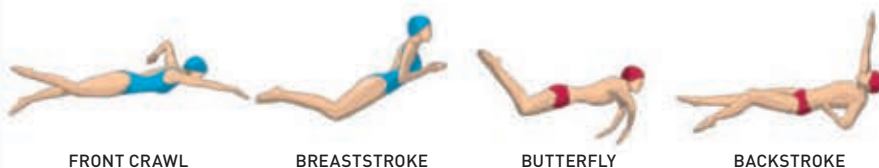
To glide through the water at great speed, swimmers must perfect their arm strokes and leg kicking so each movement propels them forwards.

### SYNCHRONIZED SWIMMING

Synchronized swimmers must perform a graceful routine in perfect unison. Music is played both above and below the water to help them keep time.

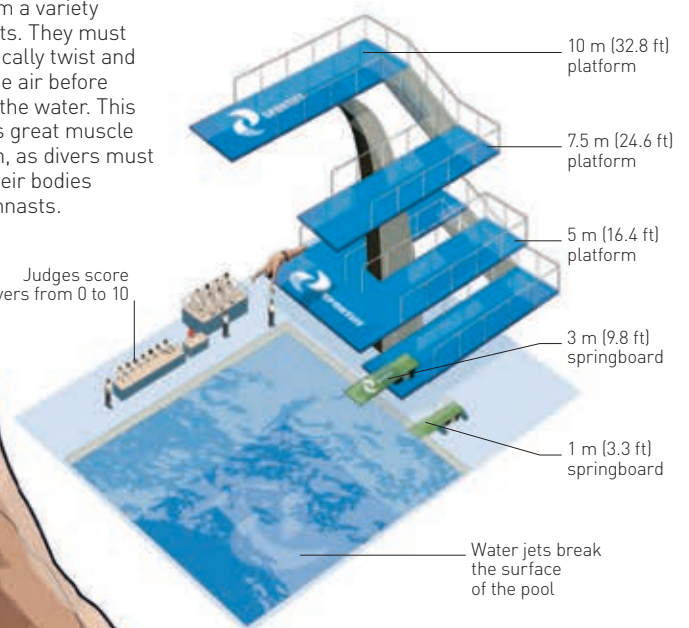
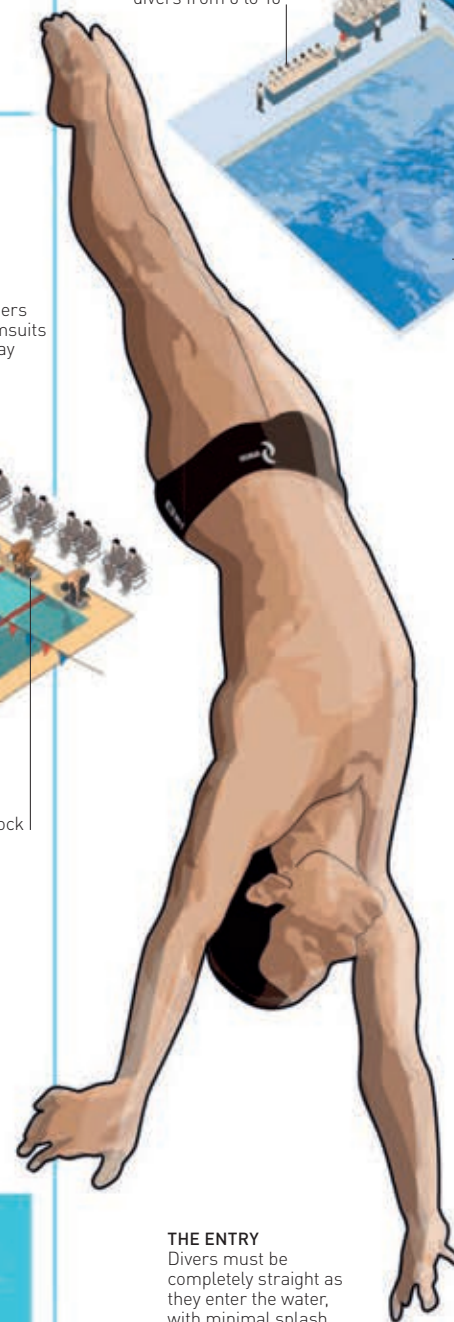
### SWIMMING STROKES

There are swimming competitions for all four types of swimming strokes. The fastest stroke is the front crawl. In the individual medley, swimmers must swim all four strokes.



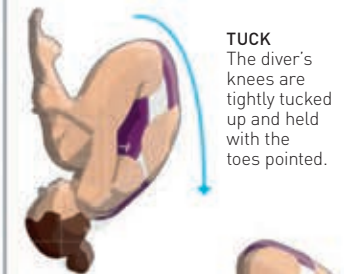
## DIVING

Competitive divers dive from a variety of heights. They must acrobatically twist and flip in the air before they hit the water. This requires great muscle strength, as divers must move their bodies like gymnasts.

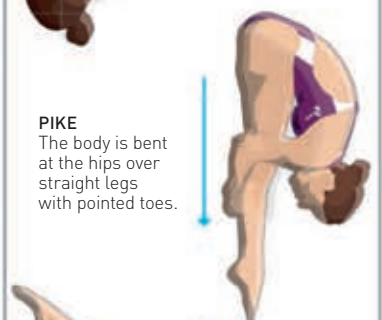


### DIVING TECHNIQUES

To achieve the highest scores, divers must complete a dive that is technically challenging. They are scored on their approach, flight, and entry into the water.



**TUCK**  
The diver's knees are tightly tucked up and held with the toes pointed.



**PIKE**  
The body is bent at the hips over straight legs with pointed toes.



**STRAIGHT**  
The body must be totally flat and rigid with pointed toes.

### THE ENTRY

Divers must be completely straight as they enter the water, with minimal splash.

## BALL SPORTS

A number of team ball sports take place in water, such as water polo and underwater hockey. In water polo, players must tread water for long periods of time. In underwater hockey, they need to be able to dive underwater.



### WATER POLO

Teams score goals by throwing a ball into a net.



### UNDERWATER HOCKEY

Teams use snorkels and a stick to get the puck into the goal.